

AI VENDOR EVALUATION

Questions to Ask Any AI Vendor

A quick-reference checklist before you sign anything. Print it, bring it to the demo.

Data & Security

- ☐ Exactly where does our data live, and who inside their company can access it?
- ☐ Is our data used to train their models - for us, or for other customers?
- ☐ What's their SOC 2 / ISO 27001 status, and can we see the actual report?
- ☐ What happens to our data, fully, if we cancel or don't renew?

Integration & Fit

- ☐ Which of our specific systems does it connect to - by name, not "supports APIs"?
- ☐ What's the realistic implementation timeline, based on a comparable customer?
- ☐ Who on our side needs to own configuration and ongoing maintenance?
- ☐ What breaks if our team turns over mid-implementation?

Model & Transparency

- ☐ What model(s) power this, and do we get notice before they change?
- ☐ How does the system handle errors or hallucinated output in practice?
- ☐ Can we see where a given output or recommendation came from?
- ☐ What are the stated limitations they'd tell a regulator, not a prospect?

Commercial & Contract

- ☐ What does pricing look like at our actual scale, not pilot volume?
- ☐ What are the real exit and data-portability terms?
- ☐ Where does lock-in actually happen - data, workflow, or integrations?
- ☐ What's excluded from the quoted price that we'll hit later?

Support & Roadmap

- ☐ Who do we actually call when something breaks, and what's the SLA?
- ☐ What's on their 12-month roadmap, and how often do they ship breaking changes?
- ☐ Can we talk to a reference customer of similar size, unscripted?

Internal Readiness

- ☐ Do we have a named owner for this tool after the sale closes?
- ☐ How will we know in 90 days if this actually worked?
- ☐ What's our fallback if this vendor doesn't deliver?

Evaluating more than one vendor?

Our AI Vendor Selection & RFP kit turns this into a weighted, scored comparison matrix across every finalist.

[Book a Strategy Call ->](#)